

Eos User's Guide
Audio Damage, Inc.
Release 2.5



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Credits

Software Design and Construction, Documentation

Chris Randall

Adam Schabtach

Reverberation Algorithms and Implementation, Reverberant Words of Wisdom

Sean Costello, Valhalla DSP

Field Testing

Jens Algren

Eric Beam

Steve Hamman

Jeff Laity

Christian Puffer

Pierre Nuage

Joshua Schnable

Made Possible By

Tracie

Elle

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System Requirements

The following table summarizes the operating system requirements and formats provided for Eos. Eos is a 64-bit plugin.

Operating System	Minimum Version	Formats
macOS	10.13	AAX, AudioUnit, CLAP, VST3; Intel and Apple Silicon
Windows	10.0	AAX, CLAP, VST3
Ubuntu	18.0	CLAP, LV2, VST3
iOS (separate purchase)	iOS 12	AUv3

Demonstration Version

We encourage you to download and try the demonstration version of Eos before purchasing it. The demo version of Eos is the same as the regular version, but has the following limitations:

- Presets cannot be saved, nor can parameter values or other settings. This includes the information usually stored by your host DAW. If you save a DAW session with an instance of the demo version of Eos, Eos will revert to its default state when you reload the session.
- Eos will cease to emit audio at all 20 minutes after you add it to your DAW session. You can remove it and add it again, but it will revert to its default state.

New in Version 2.5

Version 2.5 introduces a new reverberation algorithm (variety being the spice of signal processing as well as life), 20 new presets, improvements to the preset browser, and a number of under-the-hood tweaks and tune-ups.

New in Version 2.2

Version 2.2 includes Apple M1 versions, a new preset manager, and some GUI touch-ups. Note that on macOS the preset location is now `~/Music`. If you have made presets, you will need to move them manually from their old location to the new one.

New in Version 2.1

Version 2.1 is primarily a maintenance release of Eos with some behind-the-scenes improvements, but sports a new, fully resizable, more legible user interface.

New in Version 2.0

Version 2.0 is a major rewrite of Eos which includes the following improvements:

- A new plate algorithm
- VST 3 compatibility
- A cross-platform XML-based preset file system
- A new GPU-based user interface, with the crossover frequency controls exposed
- Built with up-to-date code libraries for better host compatibility and future-proofing

All of the original factory presets are still available. However, since Eos 2.0 is a different plug-in than version 1.x from your host software's perspective, any presets you created with version 1.x will not be available in this version.

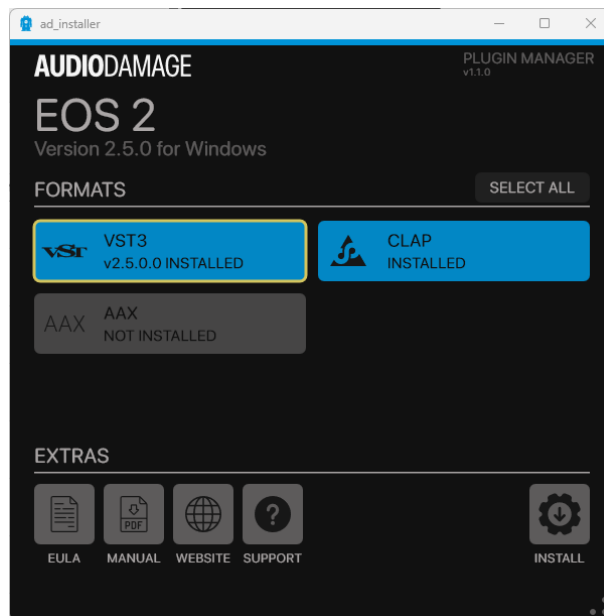
Introduction

Thanks for purchasing Eos, the algorithmic reverb plug-in from Audio Damage. Eos consists of three high-quality custom-designed reverb algorithms, made with the modern production environment in mind. Three different plate simulators and our own SuperHall algorithm give you a broad palette of reverb, and the easy-to-understand interface makes adjusting the algorithms to suit your track incredibly simple.

Want a traditional dark plate reverb? Eos can do that. How about a short, dense room sound for your drum buss? Not a problem. But where Eos really comes in to its own is when you drop SuperHall on your piano or synthesizer tracks. The incredibly long modulated hall sounds of Eno-style ambience are where Eos thrives, something that is made of unobtainium with convolution 'verbs. Quite simply, an impulse response cannot do what Eos does. Period.

Installation

Eos uses our custom plugin manager application for installation. Launch it as usual on your operating system of choice and you'll be presented with a window like this:



Near the top of the window, beneath the large word EOS, you'll see the version number of the software carried by the installer. This is distinct from the version of the plugin manager itself, which is shown in the upper right and usually not of much interest.

Under the heading FORMATS are large buttons corresponding to the plugin formats which can be installed: AAX, AU, CLAP, LV2 and/or VST3, depending on the operating system. If the plugin is already present on your system in one or more formats (i.e. if you're upgrading from a previous version), the corresponding button is drawn in blue. When possible, the version number of the existing plugin is also shown.

Click a button to select the format for installation. A yellow outline appears around the button to indicate that its format will be installed. In the above screenshot, VST3 and CLAP are installed, AAX is not installed, and VST3 is selected for installation. The older instance of the VST3 plugin will be overwritten by the version contained in the plugin manager. Clicking a button a second time removes the yellow outline, and the corresponding format will not be installed. Clicking the SELECT ALL button selects all available formats for installation.

No changes to your system's storage device take place until you click the INSTALL button near the lower-right corner of the window. Click that button and you'll receive visual confirmation that the formats you've selected have been installed. (Yes, it happens quickly.) On Windows and Linux, if you hold down the Shift key on your keyboard, the INSTALL button's label switches to UNINSTALL, and clicking it will remove the selected formats from your system¹. Once you're installed and/or removed the formats you need, simply close the application in the usual manner for your operating system. You're done. There is no license code or other authorization necessary; we'd rather assume we can trust you than burden you with an onerous DRM system.

You'll find some handy buttons under the EXTRAS heading, all of which are pretty self-explanatory:

EULA – presents the End-User License Agreement for our products. By clicking the INSTALL button you're implicitly agreeing to these terms, but we expect that you'll find them reasonable should you take the time to read them.

MANUAL – opens the current version of this user manual, in PDF form, in your web browser.

WEBSITE – opens the product's web page in your browser.

SUPPORT – displays information for contacting us, either via our Discord presence or through email.

¹ Blame Apple, not us, for the lack of this feature on macOS. On macOS just manually delete the plugin(s) from your plugin folder(s).

Operation

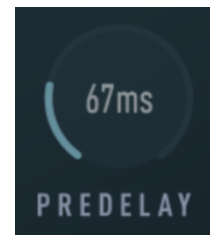
Eos can be used in a mono-in/stereo-out or stereo-in/stereo-out context. Of the three reverb types in Eos, one, Plate One, always sums its inputs to mono and is tailored for mono-in usage. The other two types have stereo inputs. The reverberators create a stereo output signal even if the input signal is mono. The dry signal is always passed through without summing.

Eos provides a number of presets to help you find settings appropriate for different instruments and contexts. We suggest that you give Eos a try right away by dropping it into one of your current projects and flipping through the presets. Once you've heard what Eos can do, come back to this manual when you'd like to read about how to tailor Eos to your musical needs.

We'll describe each of Eos's controls in turn, starting with the controls at the top left of the window.

Pre-Delay

The pre-delay simply delays the incoming signal before it reaches the reverberators, and hence how long the reverberant sound will be delayed relative to the dry signal. Typically pre-delay is added to a reverb effect to increase the perceived size of the simulated reverberant space: the bigger the space, the longer it takes the reflected sound to reach the ears of the listener. Pre-delay also has creative applications. If the processed signal is delayed enough, relative to the original signal, it becomes a separate sonic element. This works particularly well with percussive sounds if the **DECAY** time is set fairly short. Eos's pre-delay has a range of zero to 300msec, or 0.3 seconds.



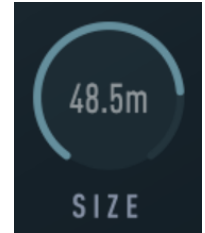
Diffusion



The **DIFFUSION** knob controls how much the initial density of echoes (often known as early reflections) builds up over time. Turning up the diffusion increases the build-up of echoes immediately following the original signal. High diffusion settings work well for percussion, but may sound too cluttered for vocals and full mixes.

Size

The **SIZE** control varies the apparent size of the simulated acoustic space or the simulated metal plate. As will be evident when you listen to it, rotating the **SIZE** knob changes the “bigness” of the reverberated sound. The range of this control is 1-60 meters, although this is a somewhat arbitrary scale.



Modulation Depth and Rate

The **MOD DEPTH** and **RATE** knobs apply time-varying changes to the delay lines within the reverberators. Modulation in a reverb serves two purposes. First, when applied in small amounts, it makes the reverb effect seem more realistic and less artificial since its timbre changes subtly over time. The modulation also breaks up any strong resonances in the reverberation network, reducing any tendency for it to sound metallic.

Second, when applied in large amounts, modulation changes reverberation from a spatial enhancement to a special effect. Large amounts of modulation create pitch changes in the reverb. While too much modulation can cause unpleasant pitch bends, just the right amount creates a rich chorusing effect when combined with the original signal.

Modulation is one of the respects in which algorithmic reverbs such as Eos differ from convolution-based reverbs. An impulse response cannot recreate the way a modulated reverb changes over time. In much the same way that a single sample cannot reproduce the timbral repertoire of an acoustic instrument, an impulse response cannot reproduce the sonic richness of an algorithmic reverb.

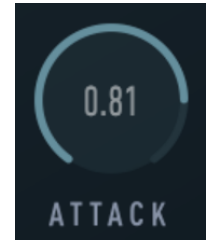
Obviously, then, modulation must be applied with care, depending on both the effect you want to achieve and the instrument(s) you're using. Eos provides two modulation controls, rate and depth. **RATE** controls how fast the modulating signal changes, and **DEPTH** controls how much the modulating signal affects the reverb.

The **RATE** knob has a range of zero to five Hertz (cycles per second). Turning up the **RATE** knob makes the sense of motion in the reverb more rapid. Eos's modulators change shape randomly to make the modulation unpredictable and hence more interesting to our ears. The **DEPTH** knob has a range of zero to 100%. Turning up the **DEPTH** control makes the modulation stronger and more audible. If either of these knobs is set to its lowest position, you won't hear any modulation at all.



Attack

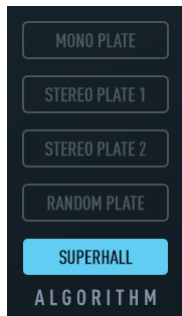
The effect of the **ATTACK** control varies depending on which reverb type is selected. If one of the Plate types is selected, **ATTACK** controls the immediate impact of the reverb, with higher settings of **ATTACK** resulting in a more "present" or direct sound. Higher Attack settings also help retain the stereo imaging of the input signal, while lower settings produce a more blended stereo image in the tail.



If the SuperHall type is selected, **ATTACK** controls the slope of the initial reverb decay. At high Attack settings, the tail exponentially decays at a rate determined by the **DECAY** control. At mid settings of **ATTACK**, the initial reverb decay is fairly flat, which can produce a "gated" effect with larger settings of Size and shorter settings of **DECAY**. When **ATTACK** is at a minimum, the reverb tail slowly fades in, at a rate determined by **SIZE**. Setting **SIZE** to large values, **DECAY** to its minimum value, and **ATTACK** to its minimum can produce a pseudo-reverse sound.

Algorithm (Type)

Eos contains four different reverberation types: Mono Plate, Stereo Plates 1 and 2, and SuperHall. Click on the names near the center of Eos's window to choose the different types. Each type has its own sonic characteristics and hence different uses.



MONO PLATE is inspired by the digital plate emulations of the 1970's, but with far more echo and density. This reverb type adds the inputs together to a mono signal and creates an artificial stereo output. Mono Plate has a natural decay at all settings of Decay and Size, and can be used to emulate small to large rooms as well as plates. Mono Plate lacks the metallic sound of most plate reverb and plate emulations, except at small Size settings. Mono Plate produces a sound with the enveloping impact of a plate reverb while remaining fairly colorless.

STEREO PLATE 1 is similar to Mono Plate, but with stereo inputs instead of mono and a higher echo density. Use Stereo Plate 1 on stereo mixes that may have cancellations when summed to mono, or when you desire the richest plate sound. **STEREO PLATE 2** is a variation of Stereo Plate 1, with a wider stereo image and a smoother reverberation tail.

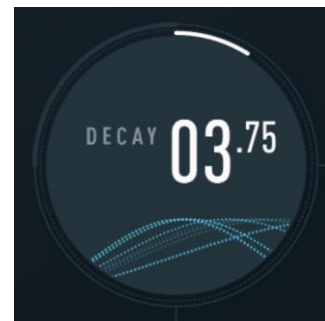
RANDOM PLATE (new in version 2.5) is something of a hybrid, incorporating characteristics of both Stereo Plate algorithms, producing a smooth, medium-density plate sound.

SUPERHALL is sonically inspired by the classic Concert Hall reverberators of the late 1970's and early 1980's. SuperHall retains the expansive imaging and gentle modulation of those devices while updating the echo density and richness to modern standards. SuperHall excels at long, gently modulating tails, producing a flattering sonic wash.

Decay

The **DECAY** parameter controls how long it takes for the reverberated sound to fade out. This control has the greatest influence on the overall sound of the effect. The range of this control is 0.1 to 10 seconds, which is approximately the amount of time that it takes the reverb sound generated by a full-volume signal to fade to silence. The actual amount of time it takes the signal to fade out is also affected by the reverb type, the **SIZE** control, and the frequency multiplier controls (described below), so the numeric value of decay should be considered a relative value.

Long reverb times are associated with large acoustic spaces, e.g., a large concert hall has a longer reverb time than your bathroom. If you're striving for a realistic reverberation effect you will not want to combine a long **DECAY** setting with a small **SIZE** setting. On the other hand, don't let the pursuit of realism discourage you from combining extreme parameter settings to create unusual effects.



Infinite

The **INFINITE** button, when turned on, effectively sets the decay time of the reverberators to infinity. Any signal present in the plug-in when you turn the infinite button on will be frozen, somewhat like a looped sample. When you turn the infinite button off, the usual decay time is restored and the reverb fades out normally. Obviously the infinite control is suited to creating unusual effects and is not likely to be something you use every day (unless, of course, creating unusual effects is your daily work).

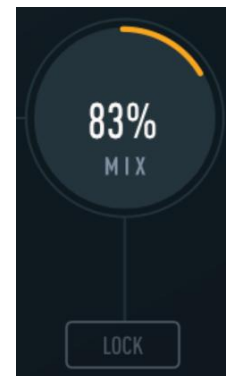


Eos will process any signals arriving at its inputs when infinite is turned on. This means that the infinite mode works best with very sparse source material. As long as infinite is on, new signals will be added to the sounds circulating in the reverb, building up and eventually becoming loud and distorted. Whether or not this is useful to you is your choice; we just wanted to warn you of the hazard.

Mix and Lock

The **MIX** knob adjusts the relative loudness of the processed signal and the original signal. If you set it at zero, you'll hear only the original, unprocessed signal. If you set it at 100%, you'll hear only the reverberation. You can probably guess what happens if you set it somewhere in between, right?

Where you should set the **MIX** control depends upon how you're using the plug-in within your host program. If you're using it as a send effect, set the control to 100% so that only the processed signal is present in the output since the dry signal is already entering your host's mixer. If you're using it as an insert effect on an instrument channel, usually you'll want a setting somewhere between 30 and 50% so that you hear more or less equal amounts of the instrument's signal and the reverberation. Let your ears be your guide, as always.



If you engage the **LOCK** button below the Mix knob, the Mix parameter will not change when you load presets. Since it's likely that you'll want to put Eos in as either a send or an insert effect, set the **MIX** control accordingly and turn on **LOCK** while you try different presets, the **MIX** control does not change when you switch presets.

Reverb Frequency Multipliers

The **LOW MULT** and **HIGH MULT** knobs control filters that change the frequency response of the reverberators and hence the tonal quality of the reverb tail. The **LOW MULT** (short for multiplier) setting determines whether low frequencies are boosted or attenuated. This control has a range of 0.5 to 2.0. If its value is less than one, low frequencies decay more rapidly within the reverberator, relative to mid-range and high frequencies. If its value is greater than one, low frequencies decay more slowly relative to other frequencies. If you're looking for that low-end "bloom" popular in reverb sounds from the 1980s, crank up the **LOW MULT**.

The **HIGH MULT** (short for high multiplier) works in a similar manner, but operates on high frequencies and only provides settings for attenuation—that is, making high frequencies decay more rapidly than the rest of the reverb tail. It has a range of 0.5 to 1.0.



The operating frequencies of these filters are controlled by the **LOW X-OVER** (crossover) and **HIGH X-OVER** knobs present in the lower-right corner of the window. Changing the **LOW X-OVER** knob adjusts the frequency range affected by the **LOW MULT** knob. The **HIGH X-OVER** knob adjusts the frequency range affected by the **HIGH MULT**.

Input Equalizers

Eos employs a pair of simple EQ filters at the inputs of the reverberators to control the overall tonal character of the reverb. The low-cut filter reduces the low frequencies ("bass") and the high-cut filter reduces the high frequencies ("treble"). Changing the **LOW CUT** control changes the frequency at which low signals are reduced; changing the **HIGH CUT** control changes the frequency at which high signals are reduced. The **LOW CUT** control has a range of 20-2000Hz; the **HIGH CUT** control has a range of 200-20000Hz.

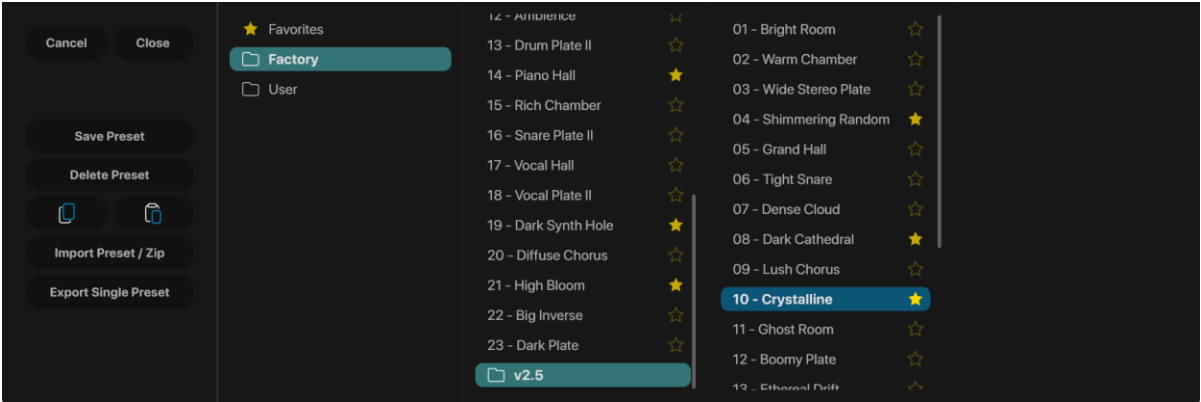
It's worth noting that reverb rarely needs to have a full 20kHz bandwidth. High frequencies tend to be absorbed by the surroundings (walls, carpets, people, etc.) rather than reflected so our ears are accustomed to hearing reverb without much high-frequency content. One early hardware reverberator, the Ursa Major Space Station, had a bandwidth of only 7kHz. While this seems almost laughable by today's standards, that bandwidth was very much a part of its characteristic and popular sound. When its creator developed a modern reissue of the Space Station, he carefully preserved and recreated the 7kHz bandwidth, even though contemporary DSP hardware is capable of a much higher frequency response.

Presets

Eos includes a collection of presets to serve as a demonstration of its capabilities and inspirations for your own creations. There are a few controls at the top of the window associated with presets:



The name of the current preset appears in the center. (You probably figured that out yourself.) Clicking the triangles on the left and right loads presets in alphabetical order. Clicking the star outline marks the preset as a favorite to help you find it again in the future. To examine all of the presets, click the name of the current to open the preset browser.



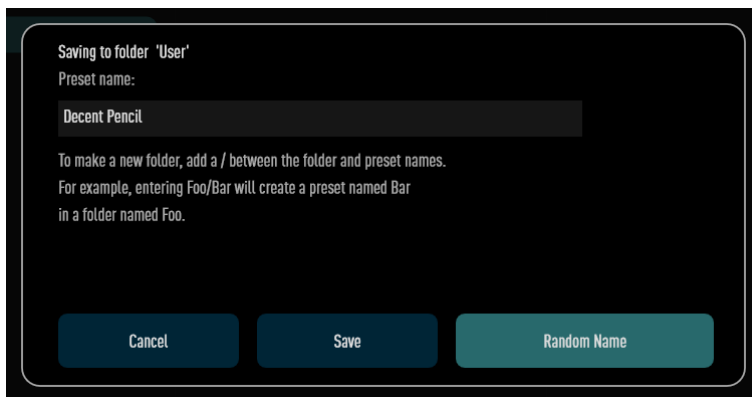
The browser displays presets and folders in scrollable lists, arranged in columns. The leftmost list shows the folders within Eos’s preset collection, grouped in two categories: Factory and User. Clicking any of these folders reveals its contents in the next list. Clicking on a preset name loads the settings into Eos. Click the **Close** button in the preset browser to dismiss it. If you click the **Cancel** button instead, the browser closes and Eos’s settings revert to their previous state. Double-clicking a preset name loads the preset and dismisses the preset browser. **Loading a preset irretrievably erases the current settings**, so if you have created something that you want to use again, save it as a new preset before loading another preset.

Once you have clicked on any item in the panel, you can navigate within the preset browser with the keys on your keyboard. The left and right arrow keys move the selection between columns, and the up and down arrow keys move it within the list. Tapping the ESC key has the same effect as clicking the Cancel button.

Just like the star at the top of the window which we mentioned previously, the stars to the right of preset names mark presets as favorites. Clicking a filled star removes the mark from a favorite. Once you've marked at least one favorite, a correspondingly named category appears in the leftmost column. Clicking it shows you all the presets you've marked, and clicking their names loads them as usual.

The folders and presets in the browser correspond to folders and files within Eos's own folder on your storage device (i.e. your computer's hard drive or SSD). This folder is located at `C:\ProgramData\Audio Damage\Eos\` on Windows, and `~/Music/Audio Damage/Eos/` on macOS and Linux. You can store your presets anywhere you like, but for them to show up in the User list they must be placed in the User folder within Eos's folder. Also, to avoid possible collisions during future updates, do not store your presets within the Factory folder.

Any folders you create within the User folder will show up as folders in the User list. You can create sub-folders within the User folder, and sub-folders within those folders. You can't nest folders deeper than that because the preset browser has only four lists. You can move presets and folders by dragging and dropping them from one list to another.



To save your presets, click the Save Preset button at the left edge of the window. This invokes a dialog box with a couple of helpful features. As the text therein describes, you can create a folder within the destination

folder (whose name is given at the top of the dialog box) by adding the folder's name to the beginning of the preset's name, separated by a slash mark.

Clicking the Random Name button replaces the preset's name with a pair of words chosen at random from two lists. While the resulting names won't have any connection with what the plugin is doing, you may find this feature useful for coming up with alternatives to routine names like "My Preset 12".

Potential pitfall: once you've saved a preset, clicking its name in the list loads the preset, overwriting whatever changes you've made since you saved the preset. Hence if you want to save the preset again to preserve the changes you've made, **do not** click on its name before saving it.

You can delete presets and folders from the lists by clicking their name and then clicking the Delete Preset or Delete Folder button. Eos will give you a chance to confirm this action or cancel it. If you confirm, the preset/folder will be removed from your storage system and is gone for good.

Importing and Exporting Presets

Preset files are plain-text XML files so that you can exchange them online in forums, copy them between a Windows computer and a Macintosh (and even between an iPad and a regular computer), email them to your friends, etc.

The two buttons with icons representing copying and pasting (copy on the left, paste on the right) copy Eos's current settings to the system clipboard and paste settings from the clipboard. You can use the copy and paste commands to transfer settings between two instances of Eos or paste the settings into an email message or text editor. When copied to the clipboard, presets are presented in the same XML text as used in preset files.

The Import Preset / Zip button provides a way to add presets to Eos without manually moving them into the appropriate folders in your file system. Clicking this button produces a file-browser window wherein you can select either a single preset file or a .zip file containing one or more presets. After you select the file, Eos copies the preset(s) into whichever folder you have selected in Eos's preset list, unzipping the file first if necessary.

Depending on whether you've selected a preset or folder, the Export Single Preset or Export Folder As Zip button performs the complementary functions of the Import button. First select either a preset or a folder in Eos's list, then click the export button. A file-save window appears; choose a location in your file system, give the file a

name, and click Save. If you have chosen a folder in Eos's preset list, the plugin places it and all of the presets it contains in a .zip file.

Default Preset

If you save a preset with the special name "Default" in the User folder, new instances of Eos will load it automatically when you add it to your DAW session. You can use a default preset file to give yourself the same starting point with Eos whenever you use it. The plugin installer creates a default preset file for you but feel free to replace it with your own.

Automation

All of Eos's parameters can be automated using your host's automation features. Consult your host's documentation for information on how to use these features.

And Finally...

Thanks again for purchasing Eos. We make every effort to ensure your satisfaction with our products, and want you to be happy with your purchase. Please write info@audiodamage.com if you have any questions or comments.